

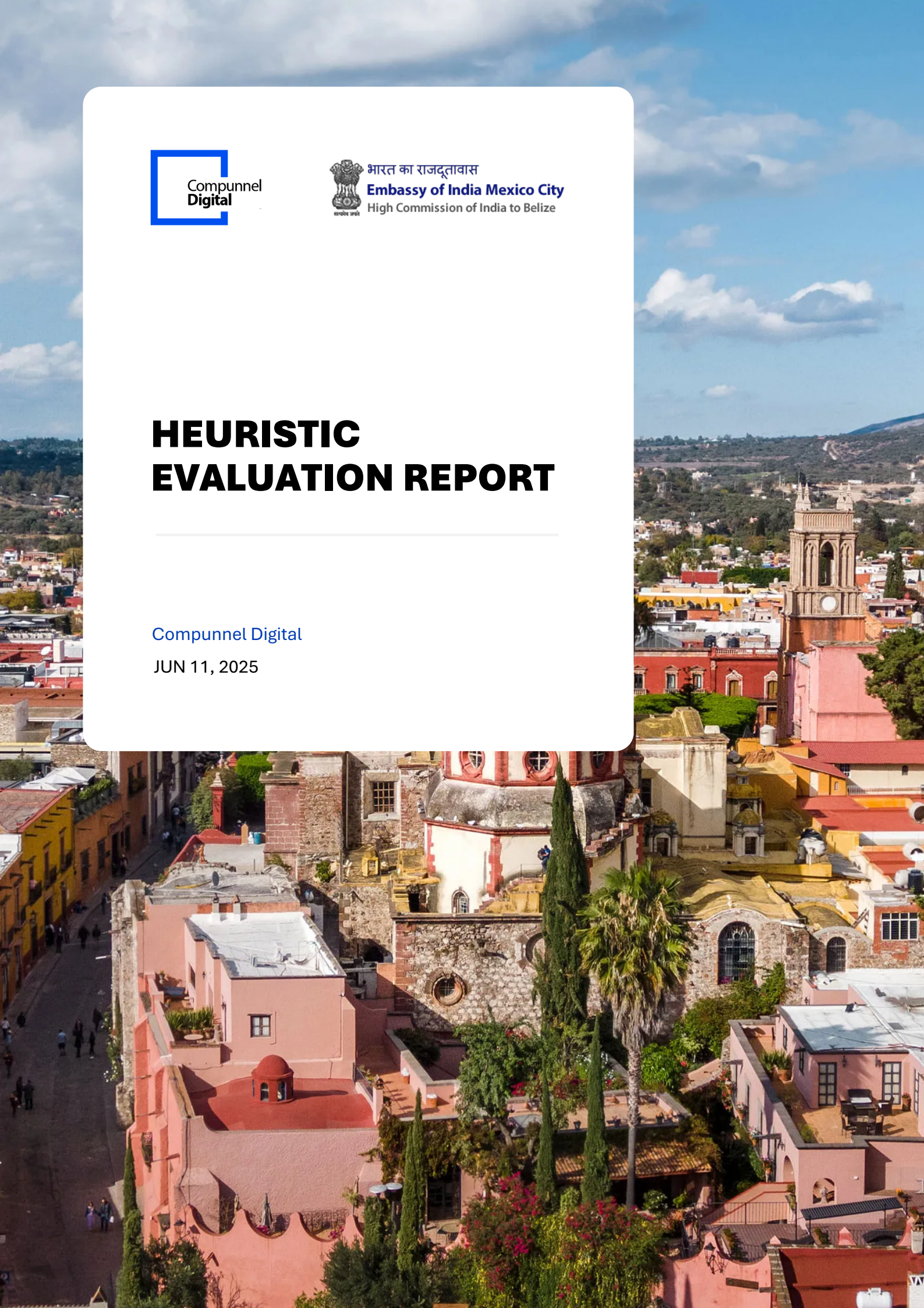


भारत का राजदूतावास
Embassy of India Mexico City
High Commission of India to Belize

HEURISTIC EVALUATION REPORT

Compunnel Digital

JUN 11, 2025



HEURISTIC EVALUATION REPORT

Embassy of India, Mexico

Website UX Review

Website	https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/
Review basis	Live website + published sitemap / information architecture
Evaluation framework	Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
Review date	9 September 2026
Scope	Navigation, content organization, findability, task flows, consistency, feedback, accessibility cues and trust

Overall assessment: The site provides a broad and valuable set of embassy, consular, commercial, education, cultural and media information, but the current experience is heavily content-led rather than task-led. The largest usability risks are information overload, deep/uneven navigation, inconsistent naming and grouping, and weak prioritization of high-intent services.

1. Executive Summary

The heuristic review assessed the existing Embassy of India, Mexico website against Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics. The review focused on the live information architecture, global navigation, sitemap structure, homepage content, service discovery and representative content pages.

The website has strong informational breadth and provides critical pathways for citizens and visitors, including appointment booking, visa, passport, OCI, miscellaneous consular services, emergency assistance, commercial information, education opportunities, cultural programs, media content and embassy contacts.

However, the architecture exposes users to a large number of links and mixed content types. The sitemap currently places transactional services, informational articles, downloadable forms, external resources, newsletters and historical content within the same broad navigation system. This increases cognitive load and makes it difficult for users to determine the correct next step.

2.1 Overall Heuristic Severity Summary

Heuristic	Severity	Assessment	Primary implication
1. Visibility of system status	2 / Minor	Moderate	Some useful status signals, but task progress and service states are not consistently surfaced.
2. Match with real world	2 / Minor	Mixed	Official terminology is accurate but often organization-centric rather than user-task-centric.
3. User control & freedom	2 / Minor	Mixed	External links and document-heavy flows can make recovery/navigation less predictable.
4. Consistency & standards	3 / Major	Needs improvement	Naming, grouping, page patterns and link treatment

			vary across the information architecture.
5. Error prevention	3 / Major	Needs improvement	High-stakes services need clearer prerequisites, eligibility, steps and warnings before action.
6. Recognition rather than recall	3 / Major	Needs improvement	Users must scan many links and infer which service/category applies to their situation.
7. Flexibility & efficiency	3 / Major	Needs improvement	Frequent users lack strong task shortcuts, service hubs and contextual cross-links.
8. Aesthetic/minimalist design	3 / Major	Needs improvement	Content volume and navigation density compete with priority information.
9. Help users recover from errors	2 / Minor	Mixed	Contact/support information exists, but help is not always contextual to the task.
10. Help & documentation	2 / Minor	Good breadth, weak findability	Documentation is extensive, but discoverability and grouping can be improved.

Priority finding: The biggest UX opportunity is to reorganize the site around user intent and tasks—especially consular services—rather than simply exposing the organization’s content inventory.

2. Methodology & Scope

- Framework: Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics.
- Evidence reviewed: live homepage, sitemap, representative Consular, Commercial and Contact pages, plus the published website structure.
- Primary user groups considered: Indian nationals in Mexico/Belize, visa applicants, passport/OCI users, overseas visitors, businesses, students, cultural audiences, media and general public.
- Evaluation approach: expert review of information architecture, navigation, content hierarchy, labeling, task discoverability, feedback, consistency, accessibility cues and support pathways.
- This is a heuristic assessment, not a usability test with recruited participants. Findings should be validated with task-based user testing and analytics.

3. Existing Experience Observations

- The global navigation contains major sections including Embassy, Bilateral Relations, Commercial, Consular, ITEC/Education, Culture, Media Centre, Contact Us and Tenders.
- The sitemap exposes a very large content inventory, with multiple nested levels and mixed content types. [\[cite?turn0view0?\]](#)
- Consular content spans appointment booking, visa, passport, OCI, miscellaneous services, forms, overseas voters, emergency assistance and other notices. [\[cite?turn0search6?turn0search7?\]](#)
- The homepage prominently provides emergency contact information and general consular phone numbers, which is appropriate for high-intent users. [\[cite?turn0search0?\]](#)
- The contact page provides extensive email, telephone, emergency and location information, but the quantity of contact channels increases the importance of clear labeling and routing. [\[cite?turn0search1?\]](#)
- Commercial content mixes embassy contacts, investment information, business guidance and external platforms such as Invest India, Make in India and IndMex. [\[cite?turn0search3?turn0search4?\]](#)
- The site includes accessibility controls such as contrast, text-size, highlight links, hide images and cursor controls. [\[cite?turn0view0?\]](#)

4. Detailed Heuristic Findings

H1 — Visibility of System Status [2 — Minor]

The site provides useful signals such as current embassy/local time, visitor count, last-updated dates and emergency notices. However, these signals are not consistently connected to the user's task. For transactional journeys, users need clearer confirmation of where they are, what step they are on, what is required next and whether they are leaving the embassy site.

Recommended improvements

- Add breadcrumb trails on all deep pages.
- Show clear task-state indicators for appointment/service journeys.
- Use prominent 'Updated on' or 'Last reviewed' labels on high-stakes guidance.
- Clearly label external destinations before users leave the site.

H2 — Match Between System and Real World [2 — Minor]

The site uses official embassy and government terminology, which supports authority and accuracy. The challenge is that many labels reflect institutional categories rather than the way users formulate needs—for example, users think 'renew passport', 'apply for OCI' or 'get a visa', while the architecture often presents departmental or document-oriented groupings.

Recommended improvements

- Introduce user-task labels alongside official terminology.
- Create 'I want to...' service pathways for high-intent tasks.
- Use plain-language summaries before official/legal terminology.

H3 — User Control and Freedom [2 — Minor]

Users can move through the site using navigation and sitemap links, but the information architecture includes many external websites, PDFs and linked resources. Users may not always know whether a link opens a document, an external government service or another embassy page.

Recommended improvements

- Add link-type indicators such as External, PDF and Online Application.

- Provide return/context links on document-heavy pages.
- Keep key service instructions on the embassy page even when the transaction occurs externally.

H4 — Consistency and Standards [3 — Major]

The sitemap shows inconsistent naming conventions, capitalization, content types and grouping. Some labels are services, some are publications, some are notices and others are organizations or portals. Similar content is distributed across different branches.

Recommended improvements

- Create a controlled content taxonomy.
- Standardize labels and capitalization.
- Separate Services, Information, Resources, News and Publications.
- Use consistent page templates for service pages.
- Avoid duplicate or overlapping labels such as multiple 'Study' and consular groupings.

H5 — Error Prevention [3 — Major]

Consular and passport services are high-risk tasks where an incorrect choice can result in rejected applications, missed appointments or delays. The current architecture provides extensive information, but users must often assemble the right sequence from multiple pages, notices, forms and external systems.

Recommended improvements

- Create service landing pages with eligibility, documents, fees, appointment requirements, processing expectations and application link in one place.
- Place critical warnings before users start a transaction.
- Show 'Before you apply' checklists.
- Clearly distinguish emergency assistance from routine enquiries.

H6 — Recognition Rather Than Recall [3 — Major]

The sitemap contains a large volume of links. Users need to scan and interpret many labels to determine which page is relevant. This is particularly challenging for first-time users who do not know embassy terminology.

Recommended improvements

- Create a prominent 'Popular Services' area.
- Add audience/task entry points: Indian Nationals, Foreign Nationals, Businesses, Students, Media.
- Use search suggestions and service-oriented results.
- Add related-service links within content pages.

H7 — Flexibility and Efficiency of Use [3 — Major]

The site supports a wide range of users, but frequent users would benefit from shortcuts to common services. High-value actions such as appointment booking, visa information, passport services and emergency assistance should require fewer discovery steps.

Recommended improvements

- Add persistent quick actions for Visa, Passport, OCI, Appointments, Emergency and Contact.
- Create a dedicated Consular Services hub.
- Add contextual 'Next step' and 'Related service' modules.
- Use audience-specific dashboards or quick-link groups.

H8 — Aesthetic and Minimalist Design [3 — Major]

The challenge is not simply visual styling; it is information density. The breadth of the site results in crowded navigation and competing content priorities. The homepage contains many announcements and informational elements, while essential services compete for attention.

Recommended improvements

- Prioritize task-critical information above secondary content.
- Reduce simultaneous navigation choices.
- Use progressive disclosure for long lists.
- Archive older content rather than allowing historical material to compete with current services.
- Create stronger visual hierarchy for alerts and service actions.

H9 — Help Users Recognize, Diagnose and Recover from Errors [2 — Minor]

The site provides contact channels and emergency information, which helps users recover when they are unsure. However, help is often separated from the task that caused the uncertainty.

Recommended improvements

- Place contextual help on service pages.

- Add 'If you are not sure which service you need' guidance.
- Create concise escalation paths: online help → email → phone → emergency contact where applicable.
- Explain common rejection or missing-document scenarios.

H10 — Help and Documentation [2 — Minor]

Documentation is extensive, including forms, advisories, FAQs, publications, external portals and contact information. The main weakness is findability: users may have difficulty identifying the authoritative/current document among many resources.

Recommended improvements

- Mark authoritative/current documents clearly.
- Add document metadata: updated date, audience, file type and size.
- Provide short summaries before PDFs.
- Group forms by service rather than maintaining a broad document inventory.
- Add FAQ/search support around high-volume services.

5. Cross-Cutting Information Architecture Findings

Finding	Current pattern	UX impact	Recommended direction
Organization-led navigation	Primary navigation mirrors embassy departments/topics.	Users must understand the organization to find services.	Add task- and audience-based entry points.
Mixed content types	Services, news, forms, publications, notices and external links coexist.	Users cannot easily predict what they will get after clicking.	Use content-type labels and separate service/resource models.
Consular complexity	Many high-value services and forms are distributed across a large branch.	High cognitive load and increased risk of wrong-path selection.	Create service hubs and guided flows.
Deep hierarchy	Sitemap reveals multiple nested levels.	More scanning and navigation effort.	Flatten priority pathways; use contextual related links.
External dependency	Government portals and partner sites are linked throughout.	Breaks continuity and can create uncertainty.	Clearly identify external systems and preserve instructions on the embassy site.
Historical content	Past events/newsletters coexist with current information.	Current information can lose prominence.	Move older content into archive-led experiences.

6. Priority Recommendations

P0 — Critical / high-risk tasks

- Reframe Consular Services around user tasks: Visa, Passport, OCI, Miscellaneous Services, Appointments, Emergency Assistance.
- Create consolidated service pages containing eligibility, requirements, fees, process, appointment information, forms and official application links.
- Improve labeling and hierarchy for emergency versus routine contact.
- Add strong distinction between embassy-hosted information, PDFs and external application portals.

P1 — High-impact navigation improvements

- Introduce audience/task entry points on the homepage.
- Add persistent quick links for the most-used services.
- Standardize information architecture and content naming.
- Improve breadcrumbs, related links and 'next step' guidance.
- Add current/archived status to time-sensitive content.

P2 — Experience refinement

- Improve document cards and metadata.
- Strengthen search with task-oriented synonyms and filters.
- Improve visual hierarchy and reduce competing homepage content.
- Use reusable page templates for services, notices, publications and events.
- Conduct accessibility QA beyond the visible accessibility toolbar.

7. Recommended Future Navigation Model

A future-state IA should preserve the embassy's content breadth while making the top-level experience task-oriented. The following model is recommended as a starting point for redesign and card sorting validation:

Recommended top-level area	Example contents
Services	Visa & Immigration; Passport; OCI; Miscellaneous Consular; Appointments; Emergency Assistance; Overseas Voters; Indian Citizen Registration
About the Embassy	Ambassador; Officials; Working Hours; Holidays; Location; Right to Information
India–Mexico & India–Belize	Bilateral Relations; High-Level Visits; Agreements/MoUs; Government Links; India at a Glance
Business & Trade	Commercial Representative; Doing Business; Investment in India; Exporters; Business Chambers; Trade Resources
Education & Scholarships	Study in India; Study in Mexico; Scholarships; ITEC; KIP; Vaibhav Fellowship; Student Resources
Culture	GTICC; Courses; Library; ICCR; Cultural Events; India–Mexico Cultural Connect
News & Media	Press Releases; Events; Photo Gallery; Newsletters; Publications; Archives
Contact & Support	Contact Details; Feedback; Work with Us; FAQs; Emergency Information
Tenders	Embassy Tenders; Other Tenders

8. Recommended Validation Plan

1. Run card sorting with Indian nationals, visa applicants, passport/OCI users, businesses and students to validate labels and grouping.
2. Run tree testing on the current and proposed IA using 10–15 high-value tasks.
3. Conduct moderated usability tests for Visa, Passport, OCI, Appointment Booking and Emergency Assistance.
4. Review search logs and analytics to identify the most common failed searches and high-exit pages.
5. Audit accessibility using WCAG 2.2 AA techniques, keyboard navigation, focus order, screen reader behavior and document accessibility.
6. Establish content governance for ownership, review dates, archival rules and external-link monitoring.

9. Conclusion

The existing Embassy of India, Mexico website is information-rich and operationally valuable, but its structure reflects a large content repository more than a streamlined public-service experience. The strongest opportunity is not to remove information, but to reorganize it around the jobs users are trying to accomplish.

A redesign should prioritize high-stakes consular journeys, reduce navigation complexity, clarify the difference between services and information resources, improve cross-linking and provide stronger guidance before users enter external systems. These changes would make the site easier to learn for first-time visitors while also making it faster for returning users.

10. Source References

The review was informed by the live website and its published sitemap as accessed on 9 September 2026.

- Embassy homepage: <https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/>
- Website sitemap: https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/eoimx_sitemap
- Consular Services: https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/eoimx_pages/MjMz
- Miscellaneous Consular Services: https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/eoimx_pages/MTM1
- Contact Details: https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/eoimx_pages/MTE1
- Commercial section: https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/eoimx_pages/MjMx
- Commercial Representative: https://www.indiainmexico.gov.in/eoimx_pages/MjA1